

EVIDENCE LOG

For Knee Conditions (Limitation of Flexion/Extension) VA Disability Claims

THE SMOKING GUN EVIDENCE

After years of navigating the VA claims process—as veterans ourselves—we discovered something that changes everything: **the single most powerful piece of evidence you can submit isn't officially part of a Fully Developed Claim.**

"No more convincing. Just corroboration."

When you walk into a C&P exam without this documentation, the examiner's job is to **investigate whether your condition exists and how severe it is.** They're playing detective. You're trying to convince them.

When you walk in WITH a properly completed Evidence Log, the dynamic completely shifts. The examiner's job becomes **corroborating what you've already documented.** They're not investigating—they're verifying. That's a fundamentally different exam.

HOW VA RATERS ACTUALLY EVALUATE YOUR CLAIM

Every VA disability rating—regardless of condition—is based on three core factors. Raters are trained to look for evidence of these specific elements:

FACTOR	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT RATERS LOOK FOR
FREQUENCY	How often do your symptoms occur?	Daily? Weekly? Constant? with specific triggers?
SEVERITY	How intense are your symptoms when they occur?	Pain levels (1-10)? Range of Motion loss? Duration?
FUNCTIONAL IMPACT	How do symptoms affect your daily life?	Can't work? Can't sleep? Can't lift kids? Missed events?

Why This Evidence Log Works: The template you're about to use is specifically designed to capture all three factors in a format that's easy for raters to process. When a rater opens your file and sees 30 days of documented symptoms with frequency, severity, and functional impact clearly recorded, they don't have to guess or interpret. The evidence speaks for itself.

DO NOT FILE ANY CLAIM UNTIL THIS LOG IS COMPLETED AND INCLUDED WITH YOUR SUBMISSION

KNEE CONDITIONS: CONDITION-SPECIFIC GUIDANCE

Knee ratings are primarily based on **Range of Motion (ROM)** limitations (Flexion and Extension) and **Pain on Motion**.

- **Flexion:** How far can you bend it back?
- **Extension:** Can you straighten it fully?
- **Instability:** Does it give way?

Key Concept: The "Flare-up" Rule (DeLuca v. Brown) Even if your knees are "okay" during the exam, you must document how they are **during a flare-up**. If you can't walk after 20 minutes of standing, that is your functional reality.

What to Log:

- **Pain:** Is it 3/10 normally but 8/10 after stairs?
- **Locking/Popping:** Does the knee lock up?
- **Giving Way:** Did you stumble or fall?
- **Functional Loss:** needing a brace, cane, or elevator.

Rating Criteria:

RATING	LIMITATION
0%	Full range but with pain on motion (The minimum rating if pain is present).
10%	Flexion limited to 45° OR Extension limited by 10°.
20%	Flexion limited to 30° OR Extension limited by 15°.
30%	Flexion limited to 15° OR Extension limited by 20°.

COMPLETED EXAMPLE: 7-DAY EVIDENCE LOG

Below is an example of a properly completed Evidence Log.

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Mon 1/6	0800	Stiffness 6/10. Could not straighten right leg fully.	Took elevator instead of stairs. Limped for first hour.
Tue 1/7	1800	FLARE-UP after walking dog. Knee gave way twice. Swelling visible. Pain 8/10.	Iced knee for 2 hours. Could not do yard work.

YOUR EVIDENCE LOG: 30-DAY TEMPLATE

Instructions: Complete one row per day for at least 30 consecutive days.

VETERAN NAME: _____ **CLAIM #:** _____
CONDITION: Knee Conditions (Limitation of Flexion/Extension) (DC 5260/5261) **START DATE:** _____

DATE	TIME	SYMPTOMS & SEVERITY	FUNCTIONAL IMPACT
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
...			
Day 30			

Note: Print this page multiple times to cover 30 days.